Who to Ask About Mom's Medicaid Application

Fifteen questions for a Medicaid planner, an applications specialist, the Medicaid agency, an elder law attorney and the facility, with room to write what they say.

Someone, perhaps the facility's business office, has asked whether Mom's Medicaid application has been started, and you have questions of your own. More than one person is involved in an application, and each of them can answer a different part. Bring the questions written down, ask them as they are, and write the answer under each one.

This guide doesn't answer the questions and doesn't say which matters most. The answers depend on Mom's situation and on the state she lives in, and the people below are the ones who can speak to it.

Your Medicaid planner

The person who confirms with your family which Medicaid program fits, where and how to apply, and the timing.

1. Which Medicaid program and which application fit Mom's situation?

2. Where and how is the application submitted where Mom lives?

3. When should we submit the application?

4. What documents do we need, and what dates should the statements cover?

5. We've marked some deposits, withdrawals and transfers we can't explain. Can we go through them with you before anything is sent?

6. What happens if the Medicaid agency asks us for additional information, and who replies?

An applications specialist

The person who assembles the application file, checks the answers against the supporting documents and submits the application.

1. What do you need from us for each section of the application?

2. Here are the records we haven't been able to find. What would you like us to do about each one?

3. Can we read through the application with you before it is submitted?

4. Once it has been submitted, can we have a copy of everything that was sent, the proof of submission and the case or application number?

The Medicaid agency or caseworker

The state office that takes applications and makes the decision.

1. What is the status of Mom's application, and who do we contact with questions about it?

2. This letter asks for more information. What exactly do you need, and how should it be sent to you?

An elder law attorney

For questions of law. A legal issue that comes up during the application is referred to an elder law attorney.

1. We've been told that part of Mom's situation is a legal question. What would you need from us to look at it?

2. When the decision letter arrives, is there anything in it you would want to see?

The facility's business office or social worker

For the records about Mom's stay and her care.

1. Which records about Mom's stay and her care can you give us for the application file, and who do we ask for copies?

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't answer these questions, put them in order of importance, or say what any answer means for Mom's application. Rules vary by state, and nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice. If one of these seems pressing to you, say so to the person in front of you.

Ready for the next step?

You have your questions, and you know who each one belongs to. While the answers come in, the planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to your Medicaid planner or to any conversation about paying for Mom's care.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The description of the Medicaid agency, and of the state agency as the place to check on an application, follows the two pages below. The questions come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's working list for this step. The grouping by role is ours.

1. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare.gov), Applying for Medicaid
2. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (Medicaid.gov), Where Can People Get Help With Medicaid & CHIP?
